

Thinking, Fast and Slow

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Publication context: 2011

Corpus priority: Phase 1

Document type: Synthesized RAG source dossier built from publicly available online material

Purpose In This RAG Corpus

- Foundational modern synthesis of heuristics, biases, and dual-process thinking.
- Defines the System 1 versus System 2 framing that helps explain why biased judgments feel intuitive and convincing.
- Provides direct concepts for decision-support, leadership reasoning, forecasting discipline, and AI-bias analogies.

Key Concepts And Retrieval Tags

- system_1
- system_2
- anchoring_bias
- availability_heuristic
- loss_aversion
- overconfidence_bias
- framing_effect
- base_rate_neglect

Core Learnings

- Human judgment often substitutes easy questions for hard ones, which creates predictable error under uncertainty.
- Fast, intuitive thinking is efficient and often useful, but it can produce systematic distortions when evidence is incomplete or emotionally charged.
- Confidence in a judgment is not a reliable signal of accuracy; people routinely become overly certain even when the signal is weak.
- How options are framed changes decisions even when the underlying facts are equivalent.
- Statistical thinking and reference classes are powerful counterweights to intuition-led error.

Directions, Observations, And Implications

- Use structured decision prompts that slow down evaluation when stakes are high.
- Ask for base rates, counterevidence, and alternative frames before accepting an intuitive conclusion.
- Use this material to explain hiring, performance-review, and leadership bias in plain language to end users.
- Treat strong confidence as something to calibrate, not something to reward automatically.

How This Can Be Applied In Decision Making

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How This Strengthens A Bias-Aware RAG System

- Supports explanation of human cognitive bias patterns that also appear in AI-assisted workflows.
- Improves retrieval for scenarios involving anchoring, framing, overconfidence, and evidence neglect.
- Useful as conceptual grounding for prompt instructions that distinguish intuitive impressions from structured analysis.

Limitations And Cautions

- This dossier is synthesized from public descriptions and reviews, not the full copyrighted book text.
- It is best used as a retrieval primer and should later be complemented by licensed or user-provided primary text where possible.

Source Notes

- Open Library publisher description (publisher_description):
https://openlibrary.org/books/OL36689110M/Thinking_fast_and_slow
- Apple Books publisher description (publisher_description):
<https://books.apple.com/us/book/thinking-fast-and-slow/id443149884>
- The New Yorker review (review):
<https://www.newyorker.com/magazine/2011/11/14/thinking-fast-and-slow>

RAG Ingestion Note

This document is intentionally written as a concise, retrieval-friendly synthesis rather than as a book review. It is designed to help the system retrieve named biases and decision failures, practical mitigation methods, organizational and AI-governance implications, and scenario-to-concept mappings for user prompts.